

## ALCHEMIZE RESOURCE LIBRARY · CONSULTATION READINESS

# Consultation Preparation Workbook

A consultation brief builder -- organize the situation, the records, and the questions before you sit down.

## USE THIS WORKBOOK TO

- ◆ Turn a messy situation into a one-paragraph summary
- ◆ Know exactly which records to bring and which to leave behind
- ◆ Walk in with your top three priorities already ranked
- ◆ Leave with a one-page brief you can hand to anyone

**ESTIMATED TIME**  
20-30 minutes

**HAVE NEARBY**  
Any notice, deadline, or document tied to the reason you are meeting

A useful consultation usually starts with the responsibility or decision, not a pile of documents. This page clarifies what is happening, what is blocked, and what outcome would actually help -- the raw material for the brief you will build by the end.

**START HERE**

Write these as you would explain them to a friend, not formally. You will tighten the language later.

## 01 WHAT BRINGS YOU HERE?

What are you trying to accomplish?

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What problem are you trying to resolve?

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If nothing changes, what happens next?

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## 02 IMPORTANT TIMING

| Timing item            | Date | Why it matters |
|------------------------|------|----------------|
| Deadline / filing date |      |                |
| Appointment / renewal  |      |                |
| Notice received        |      |                |

### Why timing matters first

The most useful consultation often begins with urgency. A short timeline reveals the real pressure, what has already happened, and what needs to happen next.

# Build the context

## 01 WHO OR WHAT IS ALREADY INVOLVED?

Examples: accountant, insurer, agency, lender, vendor, employer, family member, attorney, or internal team member.

| Person, agency, or system | Role in the situation | Follow-up needed |
|---------------------------|-----------------------|------------------|
|                           |                       |                  |
|                           |                       |                  |
|                           |                       |                  |

## 02 WHAT HAS ALREADY HAPPENED?

What has already been tried, and what are you waiting on?

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## 03 WHAT FEELS UNCLEAR?

### WHY THIS MATTERS

"Need clarification" means the information exists but isn't understood. "Need a decision" means more than information is needed. Naming the gap correctly saves time in the room.

NEED CLARIFICATION

NEED ORGANIZATION

NEED A DECISION

NEED A REFERRAL

# Records to bring

Bring the records that explain the fact, the question, the deadline, or the decision -- not every file in your life.

01

BRING WHAT EXPLAINS THE FACT AND THE QUESTION

- ☐
- Notices, policies, agreements, or prior filings relevant to the issue
- 
- ☐
- Correspondence that explains what changed or was requested
- 
- ☐
- Documents tied to the decision you are trying to make
- 
- ☐
- Records showing what has already happened, and what is still unresolved

02

RECORDS I MAY NEED

| Record | Why it matters | Available? |
|--------|----------------|------------|
|        |                |            |
|        |                |            |
|        |                |            |
|        |                |            |

**Security reminder**  
Do not send Social Security numbers, banking information, tax returns, identification documents, or medical information through an unsecured contact form or ordinary email. Use only an approved secure method when instructed.

# The conversation itself

## 01 QUESTIONS I WANT ANSWERED

Questions and points to clarify

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## 02 MY TOP THREE PRIORITIES

Rank what matters most

|                 | Can wait   | Time-sensitive        |
|-----------------|------------|-----------------------|
| Nice to resolve | Later      | Priority one          |
| Must resolve    | Would help | Priority two or three |

## 03 DURING THE CONSULTATION

Clarify

☐ Confirm the primary objective and what's already known versus missing

Decide

☐ Identify the real next action and who owns follow-up

Close

☐ Confirm next steps, timing, and the follow-up date

### Before you leave the room

You should leave knowing the next step, who owns it, what still needs to be done, and when follow-up should happen.

# Your one-page brief

This page pulls the workbook together into something you can hand to anyone -- your consultant, a colleague, or yourself next week.

## 01 SITUATION SUMMARY

In one paragraph: what is happening, and what outcome would help?

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## 02 THE ESSENTIALS

| Field                | Your answer |
|----------------------|-------------|
| Top priority         |             |
| Key deadline         |             |
| Who else is involved |             |
| Records I'm bringing |             |

## 03 ACTION PLAN AFTER THE CONSULTATION

| Action | Owner | Due date | Status |
|--------|-------|----------|--------|
|        |       |          |        |
|        |       |          |        |
|        |       |          |        |

### NEXT STEP

## THE BRIEF IS READY. LET'S HAVE THE CONVERSATION.

Ready to put this to use? Schedule a consultation at [getalchemize.com](https://getalchemize.com).

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This workbook provides general organizational guidance. It does not replace legal, tax, financial, insurance, or other qualified professional advice.